

Nikhil Sharma

Operations Management & Business Analytics

Fisher College of Business, The Ohio State University

On the 2026–2027 academic job market

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01 Research

Research Interests

Supply Chain Intermediaries · Third-Party Payment Contracts · Pro-Environmental Operations (AI) · Behavioral Operations

Job Market Paper

2026 MANUSCRIPT READY FOR SUBMISSION · M&SOM

Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain

with John Gray and Jurriaan De Jong

I examine regulatory actions taken by Ohio Medicaid targeting spread pricing, in which a Pharmacy Benefit Manager (PBM) bills the payer more for a drug than it reimburses the dispensing pharmacy. Using a difference-in-differences design on a coarsened exact-matched sample, complemented by an event-study analysis using synthetic controls, I find that payment transparency reduced Medicaid payer costs and lowered drug-quality risk, while a subsequent spread-pricing ban reversed a substantial portion of the cost savings. Presented at POMS 2025, DSI 2025, POMS 2026, and ISA 2026. First Place, Hayes Graduate Research Forum 2025.

Under Review / Revise & Resubmit

2026 REJECT AND RESUBMIT · M&SOM

Improving Recycling Quality through AI and Green Nudges: Evidence from a Field Experiment

with Erin McKie, Arvind Chandrasekaran, and Sanghoon Cho

A 48-week field experiment with 7,600 Midwest households testing AI-enabled curbside feedback and two types of green nudges on recycling contamination. Presented at the UIUC Supply Chain Management Conference 2025.

2026 MAJOR REVISION · JOURNAL OF BUSINESS LOGISTICS

Emergence, Coexistence, and Dominance of Supply Chain Intermediaries: A Literature Review and Future Research Directions

with Molly Hughes, John Gray, and Jurriaan De Jong

An integrative literature review developing a conceptual framework on how and when supply chain intermediaries create and destroy value.

2026 MAJOR REVISION · HEALTH AFFAIRS SCHOLAR

Generic Drug Supply Chain Quality and Market Dynamics: A Cross-Sectional Observational Study of Metformin

with John V. Gray, Robert Handfield, and coauthors

Using FDA drug manufacturing facility inspection data on metformin, we find that inspection outcomes do not reliably predict market price or sales volume.

Working Papers & Research in Progress

2026 Multiproduct Retail Decisions under Aggregate Contracts

with James Hill and Rakesh Mallipeddi · Dissertation Chapter 2

A 2x2 laboratory newsvendor experiment comparing individual and aggregate third-party payment contracts. Lab Study 1 complete; Lab Study 2 in planning. Presented at POMS 2026.

2025 The Impact of Curbing Intermediary Practices on Retailers' Performance

with John Gray and Jurriaan De Jong · Dissertation Chapter 3

Using five-state Medicaid prescription claims data to examine how curbing intermediary practices affected retailers' product mix, drug quality, and cost pass-through. Data collection complete.

2025 The Waterbed Effect in Intermediated Supply Chains

with John Gray and Jurriaan De Jong

Exploring spillover effects of regulating intermediaries across states. Data collection complete.

2025 Multi-contract Retail Decisions under Third-Party Payments

with James Hill and Rakesh Mallipeddi

Experiment design complete.

02 Education

2022–present

Ph.D., Operations Management & Business Analytics

Fisher College of Business, The Ohio State University

2005–2009

B.E., Electronics and Communications

Institute of Technology & Management, Gurgaon (Maharshi Dayanand University, Rohtak)

03 Teaching

Instructor, Fisher College of Business

2025

BUSMGT 3230 — Introduction to Operations Management

Instructor of record. Student Evaluation of Instructor (SEI): 4.8 / 5.0.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Fisher College of Business

2022–2025

BUSMGT 3230 — Introduction to Operations Management (x2)

Including one fully online recitation.

2022–2025	BUSMGT 7223, BUSMGT 2320, BUSOBA 2321, BUSOBA 4234, BUSOBA 4254, MBA 6273, BUSOBA 7201 Project Management; Decision Sciences: Statistical Techniques; Business Analytics; Service Operations; Sustainable Projects; Data Analysis Management; Service Operations.
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Industry & Community Teaching

2013	Ad Hoc Instructor, Accenture Learning & Knowledge Management Coached professional classrooms on mainframe technology. Average feedback score: 4.2 / 5.0.
2016–2017	Mentor, Starbase CT Public speaking and robotics, Betances STEM School and Jumoke Academy, Hartford, CT.

04 Conferences & Presentations

2026	ISA Annual Meeting Regulating Powerful Intermediaries (job market paper).
2026	POMS Annual Conference Regulating Powerful Intermediaries (job market paper); Multiproduct Retail Decisions under Aggregate Contracts.
2025	DSI Annual Conference Regulating Powerful Intermediaries (job market paper).
2025	UIUC Supply Chain Management Conference Improving Recycling Quality through AI and Green Nudges.
2025	POMS Annual Conference Regulating Powerful Intermediaries (job market paper).
2025	Hayes Graduate Research Forum, The Ohio State University First Place, Business category — “Regulation of Supply Chain Intermediaries within Pharmaceutical Supply Chains.”
2025	Indian School of Business (ISB) – POMS Workshop Dissertation research on supply chain intermediaries.

05 Service & Awards

Academic Service

2025-present	Emerging-Scholar Ambassadorial Core (ESAC), Journal of Operations Management Involved in the creation of "The Doctorate in Operations Management Embassy (D.O.M.E.)"
2025-2026	Session Chair DSI Annual Conference (2025, 2026), POMS (2026), INFORMS Annual Meeting (2026).
2025-2026	Panel Co-Moderator DSI Panel on AI in Healthcare.
2026	Ad-Hoc Reviewer Decision Sciences Journal.
—	Professional Memberships INFORMS, Production and Operations Management Society (POMS), Decision Sciences Institute (DSI).

Awards

2025	First Place, Hayes Graduate Research Forum, The Ohio State University Business category, for the dissertation paper "Regulation of Supply Chain Intermediaries within Pharmaceutical Supply Chains."
2019	Top 5 Finalist Team, Accenture Global Tech Innovation Contest (North America) Chicago, IL — out of 350+ entries.
2018	Top 5 Finalist Team, Accenture Global Tech Innovation Contest (North America) Out of 350+ entries.

06 Industry Experience

Accenture, India & USA (2009-2022) — 12 years across IT operations and business analytics, with exposure to Financial Services, Life Sciences, Communication/Media/Technology, and Health & Public Services.

2014-2022	Business Analytics Consulting, Hartford, CT — Business Insurance, Travelers Transformed the claim management system supporting day-to-day SLA challenges; developed 100% automation for minor IT batch operations, saving 1,400 hours annually.
2013-2014	Business Analyst, Bangalore, India — Biopharmaceutical Research, Covance (Lab-Corp) Implemented a process-based approach for 10 applications supporting pharmacy services.

2012–2013

Product Development, Bangalore, India — KPN (Communication, Media & Technology)

Guided a 3-member team delivering a complex business requirement across six use-case modules with 0 defects.

2009–2012

Production Operations & Quality Analyst, Bangalore, India — United Health Group

Developed eight process optimizations saving \$204,720 annually; built analytics tools measuring 15+ financial KPIs, saving \$65,000 annually.

07 Skills & Training

Programming Languages & Software

R, STATA, LaTeX, Python, MS Office

Technology & Platform Training

Ab Initio, Databricks, AWS

Industry Exposure

Healthcare & Insurance, Pharmaceutical Technology, Communications/Media/Technology, General Insurance (P&C)